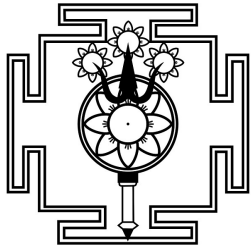
PRACTICAL PRAYERS

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PRACTICAL PRAYERS

Thirty-six prayers for the moments of the day



Practical Prayers — Thirty-six prayers for the moments of the day.
First edition.

Texts drawn from the Śaiva corpus, with translations for this edition.

Set in Cormorant Garamond and Tiro Devanagari Sanskrit.

AUDIO COMPANION
SCAN TO LISTEN TO EVERY PRAYER

ब्रह्मार्पणं ब्रह्म हविर् ब्रह्माग्नौ ब्रह्मणा हुतम्

BHAGAVAD GĪTĀ 4.24 — THE MEAL PRAYER

Why these prayers Swami Lakshmanjoo compiled his Wisdom verses in the summer of 1987 and told his devotees: "These verses are for your daily recitation. Maybe sometime you will experience these stages." Four of the six hymns in his recitation appendix live in these pages — the Krama Stotra, the Anuttarāṣṭikā, the Bhairava Stotra and the Dehastha — alongside the mealtime yajña he taught, the breath-japa of the Vijñāna Bhairava, and the dawn-dusk junction of the Tantrāloka: "the Lord must be worshipped at the point of the meeting of day and night." Nine sections — eight moments of the day, plus one for any time. Thirty-six prayers, each facing its explanation — when to do it, how, why, and what it does. Three of Swamiji's Bahurūpa hymns live in the Anytime pocket. Nothing here needs belief. The verses were built to be said — at the sink, at the desk, in the queue, in the dark.

DECODING THE VERSES — THE AXIOMS (1 OF 2)

Śiva — consciousness that is *self-lit*: knowing that needs no second thing in order to be known.

Why: any knower requiring another knower regresses forever; the chain of proof must end in something self-evidencing. That self-evidencing is what the texts name Śiva. (svaprakāśa)

Śakti — Śiva knowing himself: power not as muscle but as the act of shining.

Why: "self-lit" means lit *by itself* — that "by" is Śakti. Flame and burning are one word's two halves.

Brahman (in the meal verse) — read as Śiva in all four places: offering, oblation, fire, goal.

Why: Gītā 4.24 names them all "brahman"; if any one differed, the chain would break into parts — one substance makes the meal a self-offering. (Lakshmanjoo, mealtime teaching)

So'ham / haṃsa — the mantra already running: out *sa*, in *ha*.

Why: Vijñāna Bhairava 155 — the jīva recites it 21,600 times a day without trying; so real practice adds no sound, it only shortens the gap (Swamiji's tuṭi-method) until you notice it.

Pañcākṣara — naḥ·maḥ·śi·vā·ya = the five acts: creation, preservation, dissolution, concealment, grace.

Why: nothing in experience falls outside those five — so five sounds cover the whole cycle, which is why one mantra can be the entire practice.

Anātha — the refuge that asks for no qualifications.

Why: a protector requiring worthy applicants is a merchant; "refuge of the refugeless" (Bhairavastava 1) removes the condition — grace that cannot be refused.

DECODING THE VERSES — THE AXIOMS (2 OF 2)

Anupāya — the no-means.

Why: if every method — contemplation, japa, visualization — can be dropped and recognition still arrives, method was never the cause. Anuttarāṣṭikā 1 simply lists what must be set down.

Pratyabhijñā — recognition, not achievement: you don't come to know Śiva; you notice you never stopped.

Why: bondage must be real for liberation to be sought — yet if it were real, no freedom could ever be felt; you do feel the difference, so bondage is a misreading, and what corrects a misreading is recognition.

Svātantrya — freedom: the cause that needs no cause.

Why: every chain of causation stops somewhere or loops; the texts place the stop at freedom — the one that acts without being acted on.

Pūjā — offering as re-cognition of what is already there.

Why: the litany (Mahopadeśaviṃśatikā 13–20) proves the Lord needs nothing from the rite — what the rite changes is the offerer. The worship is the worshipper, turning.

Bhakti — the method that is not a method.

Why: Śivastotrāvalī 1 describes a devotee attained without meditation or recitation — devotion works by alignment, not technique; that is why these guides give feelings, not repetitions.

Māyā — the world's making-power, seen from underneath.

Why: the texts never deny the world — "the world, both real and unreal" (Mahopadeśaviṃśatikā 11) — they deny only the view from below that takes the making for the made.

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Anytime

no clock · pocket mantras

The Secret Remedy

श्रृणु देवी! परं गुह्यं रहस्यं परमाद्भुतम्। सर्व-पाप-प्रशमनं सर्व-दुःख-निवारणम्॥ प्रायश्चित्तेषु सर्वेषु तीव्रेष्व् अपि विमोचनम्। सर्व-च्छिद्राप-हरणं सर्वार्ति-विनिवारकम्॥ समयोलङ्घने घोरे जपादेव विमोचनम्। भोग-मोक्ष्ह-प्रदं देवी! सर्व-सिद्धि-फलप्रदम्॥

śṛṇu devī! paraṁ guhyaṁ rahasyaṁ paramādbhutam | sarva-pāpa-praśamanaṁ sarva-duḥkha-nivāraṇam || prāyaścitteṣu sarveṣu tīvreṣv api vimocanam | sarva-cchidrāpa-haraṇaṁ sarvārti-vinivārakam || samayolaṅghane ghore japādeva vimocanam | bhoga-mokṣha-pradaṁ devī! sarva-siddhi-phalapradam ||

listen, goddess: the supreme secret, most wonderful — it pacifies all sins, removes all sorrows; releases even from intense atonement, removes every gap, uproots all affliction; in the breaking of the vows the remedy is the recitation alone — it grants enjoyment and liberation, goddess, the fruits of all accomplishments.[1]

The Secret Remedy

ŚRĪ BAHURŪPA-GARBHA STOTRA, BHAIRAVA'S ANSWER (VV.5-7) · VV.5-7 · ACADEMY RECITATION PDF

The Devī asks for the easy remedy; Bhairava answers: the recitation itself.

WHAT IS IT

The hymn's frame: Bhairavī approaches Svacchanda Bhairava on Kailāśa and asks for the upāya for those who have broken the rules, however sincerely they try to atone. Bhairava's answer is not a ritual but a text — japādeva vimocanam, liberation by the recitation itself. It purifies the three channels, closes the chidras (the flaws and gaps in conduct and rite), and grants both bhoga and mokṣa. The logic of a remedy-hymn: the mantra is the medicine, and the disease is as much guilt as transgression.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

Recite it at the beginning and end of any ritual — the hymn's own instruction (yāgārambhe ca yāgānte). Also daily (nitya), on occasion (naimitika), when you want something (kāmya), for yourself or for someone else. Counting effects per the hymn: one hundred recitations purify even great sinners; fifty, inadvertent sins; twenty-five, minor sins — and a single recitation (of this hymn or of the Aghora japa) removes wrongs done by body, speech or mind, whether through inattention or knowingly.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

a stuck state — anxiety, craving, the low hum — is named as him and loses its stuckness; the secret shows as the shift.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the ease is the point — sadupāyaṁ, the remedy without strain.

Source: bahurupa-meaning.pdf · vv.5-7 · Academy recitation PDF

No Mantra Greater

विधिहीने प्रमादे च जप्तव्यं सर्व-कर्मसु । नातः परतरो मन्त्रो नातः परतरा स्तुतिः ॥ नातः परतरा काचित् सम्यक्-प्रत्यङ्गिरा प्रिये । इयं समय-विद्यानां राज-राजेश्वरी-श्वरि ॥ परमाप्यायनं देवि भैरवस्य प्रकीर्तितम् । प्रीणनं सर्व-देवानां सर्व-सौभाग्य-वर्धनम् ॥

vidhihīne pramāde ca japtavyaṁ sarva-karmasu | nātaḥ parataro mantro nātaḥ paratarā stutiḥ ‖ nātaḥ paratarā kācit samyak-pratyaṅgirā priye | iyaṁ samaya-vidyānāṁ rāja-rājeśvarī-śvari ‖ paramāpyāyanaṁ devi bhairavasya prakīrtitam | prīṇanaṁ sarva-devānāṁ sarva-saubhāgya-vardhanam ‖

when the rule is missing, when there is negligence — it should be recited in every action. no mantra is greater than this, no praise higher; no counter-formula better than this, o beloved — this queen of the knowledge of the precepts, o sovereign among isvaras! this, o goddess, is the supreme nourishment of bhairava's glorification — it satisfies all the gods and increases all good fortune.

No Mantra Greater

ŚRĪ BAHURŪPA-GARBHA STOTRA, THE CLOSE (VV.13-15) · VV.13-15 · VINIYOGA

The hymn's own claim: no mantra greater, no counter-formula better.

WHAT IS IT

Three closing claims: (1) it covers every action, including mistakes of omission and negligence (pramāda); (2) it is samyak-pratyaṅgirā — the perfect counter-charm against ritual flaw — the queen of samaya-vidyā, the knowledge of the precepts; (3) its effect is āpyāyana, nourishment — of Bhairava's glorification, pleasing to all the gods, increasing saubhāgya, all good fortune. The hymn then gives its own viniyoga: Ṛṣi Vāmadeva, meter Anuṣṭupa, devatā Bahurūpabhaṭṭāraka, purpose — removal of sins of body, speech and mind, and attainment of the four goals: dharma, artha, kāma, mokṣa.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

Full practice in the tradition: dhyāna of Svacchanda (crystal-white upward face, yellow east, blue south, pomegranate-red north, moon-white west — the twelve-verse meditation), then this hymn, then the Gāyatrī — oṁ bahurupāya vidmahe, koṭarākṣāya dhīmahi, tanno 'ghoraḥ pracodayāt, three times — then the mūla mantra. In this book's simpler use: one round of these three verses at the close of any difficult day; the line to remember is 'no mantra greater than this'.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the tongue stops wanting to stop: the mantra runs during ordinary tasks, unsummoned — addiction-to-the-name.

Source: bahurupa-recitation.pdf · vv.13-15 · viniyoga

Bahurūpa Gāyatrī

ओं बहुरुपाय विद्महे,
कोटराक्षाय धीमहि ।
तन्नो ऽघोरः प्रचोदयात्

oṁ bahurupāya vidmahe, koṭarākṣāya dhīmahi | tanno 'ghoraḥ pracodayāt

we meditate on the manifold-formed,
on the one of a hundred thousand eyes —
may the aghora impel our thought.

Bahurūpa Gāyatrī

ŚRĪ BAHURŪPA-GARBHA STOTRA — THE GĀYATRĪ · GĀYATRĪ · VINIYOGA IN RECITATION PDF

The hymn's Gāyatrī — three tenses of prayer in three lines.

WHAT IS IT

The classical Gāyatrī frame bent onto Bahurūpabhaṭṭāraka: vidmahe (we know), dhīmahi (we dwell), pracodayāt (may he impel) — knowing, dwelling, directing. Bahurūpa = manifold-formed: forms plural, power one. Koṭarākṣa, hundred-thousand-eyed, answers the dhyāna's fifteen eyes — the seeing multiplied.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

The recitation order per the viniyoga: dhyāna → hymn → this gāyatrī three times → mūla mantra. Three rounds, seed-voice. 'Pracodayāt' is the only request in the entire sequence — everything before it was arrangement.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

brow, chest and navel warm in sequence on the rounds — and the day bends toward him three times without effort.

Source: bahurupa-recitation.pdf · gāyatrī · viniyoga in recitation PDF

Oṁ Namaḥ Śivāya

ओं नमः शिवाय

oṁ namaḥ śivāya

Oṁ — I bow to Śiva.

Oṁ Namaḥ Śivāya

PAÑCĀKṢARA MANTRA · PRACTICE FILE

The most portable Trika prayer: the whole cycle of manifestation folded into sound.

WHAT IS IT

The five syllables are the five acts: naḥ creation, maḥ preservation, śi dissolution, vā concealment, ya grace. Oṁ, a+u+ṃ, is the triad of will, knowledge and action. To repeat it is to let the whole cycle turn inside you.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

Say it aloud or mentally: let naḥ open, maḥ hold, śi release, vā hide, ya return. The Name does the work — no count needed, pick it up any hour.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

The practice file's own feel track: heaviness lifting to warmth, then offering-release, luminosity, pervasion — the cycle noticed turning without your steering.

Source: namah-shivaya.json · practice file





I

Waking

on rising

Homage to the World-Formed

प्रपञ्चोत्तीर्णरूपाय नमस्ते विश्वमूर्तये ।
सदादिव्यप्रकाशाय स्वात्मनेऽनन्तशक्तये

prapañcottīrṇarūpāya namaste viśvamūrtaye | sadādivyaprakāśāya svātmane'nantaśaktaye

homage to the form that has crossed beyond the manifest — to the self of the world's form; to the ever-divinely-shining, to the self that is unending power.

Homage to the World-Formed

MAHOPADEŚAVIṂŚATIKĀ V.1 · V.1

The opener: homage to the world-formed beyond the world — the ever-shining self of unending power.

WHAT IS IT

The maṅgala names its object twice: the world's form — crossed beyond, yet still his; and the ever-divine-shining self whose power does not end. Homage lands on what already shines, not on something far away.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

On waking: recite as its placement asks. The verse's own act is namaḥ — homage, phrase by phrase, one round.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the day opens addressed: the homage lands on what was already shining — tap, floor, sky included.

Source: L2-mpa-p01.md · v.1

The Body-Temple Offering

देहो देवालयः प्रोक्तः स्वात्मा देवः सनातनः ।
त्यजेदज्ञाननिर्माल्यं सोऽहं भावेन पूजयेत्

deho devālayaḥ proktaḥ svātmā devaḥ sanātanaḥ | tyajedajñānanirmālyaṃ so'haṃ bhāvena pūjayet

the body is declared god's temple, the own self the eternal god. casting off the sweepings of ignorance, let him worship with the feeling: i-am-he.

The Body-Temple Offering

DEHASTHA V.1 · V.1

The frame vow: body is god's temple, self the eternal god — worship with I-am-He.

WHAT IS IT

The frame vow: the body is proclaimed god's temple and the own self the eternal god; the sweepings of ignorance are cast off, and worship happens as I-am-He feeling.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

The verse's own method: cast off the sweepings of ignorance and hold so'ham as the worship — the bhāva is the practice, not a formula.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the test is bhāva: I-am-he holds as feeling rather than as words — that is the verse's own criterion.

Source: deha-po1.md · v.1

The Three States as His Rays

जाग्रतस्वप्नसुषुप्त्याद्या धारयंश्च निजाः कलाः । स्वेच्छया भासि नटवन् निष्कलोऽसि च तत्त्वतः

jāgratasvapnasuṣuptyādyā dhārayaṃśca nijāḥ kalāḥ | svecchayā bhāsi naṭavan niṣkalo'si ca tattvataḥ

waking, dreaming, deep sleep and the rest — you hold them as your own portions. By your will you shine like an actor, yet you are partless in truth.

The Three States as His Rays

MAHOPADEŚAVIṂŚATIKĀ V.10 · V.10

The three states as his rays — shining like an actor, partless in truth.

WHAT IS IT

Waking, dreaming, deep sleep and the rest are held as his own rays: he shines by his own will like an actor, and is partless in truth. The states borrow the light; he does not play the parts.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

On waking: say it once. The verse itself performs the recognition — the states named as his rays, nothing else to do.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the states read as his rays — held by him, not happening to you; the actor stays partless.

Source: L2-mpa-p01.md · v.10

The Play of the Dawning

उदयावभासचर्वणलीलां
विश्वस्य या करोत्यनिशम् ।
आनन्दभैरवीं तां
विमर्शरूपामहं वन्दे

udayāvabhāsacarvaṇalīlāṃ viśvasya yā karotyaniśam | ānandabhairavīṃ tāṃ vimarśarūpāmahaṃ vande

the play of the dawning, shining forth, and chewing over of the universe, which she performs unceasingly — bliss-bhairavī, her, whose form is reflection, i praise.

The Play of the Dawning

DEHASTHA V.6 · V.6

Bhairavī beside him: the ceaseless chewing-play of the universe, reflection-formed.

WHAT IS IT

Ānanda-Bhairavī as vimarśa — the awareness-energy that chews the universe ceaselessly, non-different from Śiva as heat from fire: one aggregate of awareness, her reflection-form.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

At dawn, as placed: the verse's own act is vande — praise of the ceaseless play she keeps performing.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the play reads as hers and his at once — non-different, as heat from fire; the dawn-chewing becomes visible.

Source: deha-p01.md · v.6





II

Bathing

water & body

What Bath for the Stainless?

निर्मलस्य कुतः स्नानं वस्त्रं विश्वोदरस्य च । निर्लेपस्य कुतो गन्धो रम्यस्याभरणं कुतः

nirmalasya kutaḥ snānaṃ vastraṃ viśvodarasya ca | nirlepasya kuto gandho ramyasyābharaṇaṃ kutaḥ

for the stainless, what bath? for the world-bellied, what garment?
for the unanointed, what scent? for the lovely, what jewel?
9

What Bath for the Stainless?

MAHOPADEŚAVIṂŚATIKĀ V.14 · V.14

Shower, towel, scent, jewel — all addressed to one who needs none.

WHAT IS IT

The litany names the bathroom itself: snāna (bath), vastra (garment), gandha (scent), bharaṇa (jewel) — each with a deity stripped of the lack it serves: stainless, world-bellied (all-containing), unanointed, lovely. What looks like futility is the precise applicability of each gift: you bathe the unblemished because bathing is what love does, not what dirt requires.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

In the shower: name each item as you use it — water for the stainless, towel for the world-bellied, scent for the unanointed. The mismatch is the smile.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the shower turns comic-sacred: water for the stainless lands as gift, not chore — three items, three small bows, the water felt offered.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the water becomes an offering rather than a chore; three items, three small bows.

Source: L2-mpa-p02.md · v.14

This Body for Worship

अन्तरुल्लसदच्छाच्छभक्तिपीयूषपोषितम् /
भवत्पूजोपयोगाय शरीरम् इदम् अस्तु मे

antarullasadacchācchabhaktipīyūṣapoṣitam / bhavatpūjopayogāya śarīram idam astu me

may this body of mine — nourished by the clear, bright nectar of devotion rising within — be fit only for your worship.

This Body for Worship

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 17.26 · 17.26

The body leaves the water consecrated: today's uniform is worship.

WHAT IS IT

The body is not renounced; it is consecrated. Nourished by the clear nectar of devotion rising in the heart (antar ullasad acchāccha-bhakti-pīyūṣa), it becomes fit for pūjā — and then it is the offering itself. This is the Trika answer to body-denial: the body is the Lord's instrument, and devotion makes it luminous.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

Dressed, before leaving the bathroom: say it once and feel the freshly washed body as anointed rather than merely clean. The day ahead is the pūjā; the body is the instrument.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the spine straightens after the bath: the body reads as instrument, not object, and the first act of the day is already service.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

a slight uprightness in the spine — the instrument picking itself up.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 17.26

Waving-Lights for the Self-Shining

स्वयं प्रकाशमानस्य कुतो नीराजनं विभोः । वेदवाचामवेद्यस्य कुतः स्तोत्रं विधीयते

svayaṃ prakāśamānasya kuto nīrājanaṃ vibhoḥ | vedavācāmavedyasya kutaḥ stotraṃ vidhīyate

whence waving-lights for the self-shining lord? how is a hymn enjoined for him whom the veda cannot say?

11

Waving-Lights for the Self-Shining

MAHOPADEŚAVIṂŚATIKĀ V.17 · V.17

The mirror, the lamp: he lights himself — so the light is for you.

WHAT IS IT

Two paradoxes: an offering of light presupposes darkness in the recipient; speech presupposes an object speech can reach. The Lord is self-lit and beyond the Veda's words. The rite's use falls on the offerer — you wave the lamp so your own eyes open; you sing because the singing lights you.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

At the bathroom mirror, hand raised with the light: you are the lamp-bearer, and the face that brightens is the audience. Hum, don't articulate — you have just honoured the Vedavācāmavedya.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the mirror-wave brightens chest-first; the lamp-waving happens inward, and muttering becomes humming.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the chest brightens before the mirror does.

Source: L2-mpa-p02.md · v.17

Pardon for the Unseen

पूर्णस्य दक्षिणा कुत्र नित्यतृप्तस्य तर्पणम्। विसर्जनं व्यापकस्याऽप्रत्यक्षस्य क्षमापणम्

pūrṇasya dakṣiṇā kutra nityatṛptasya tarpaṇam | visarjanaṃ vyāpakasyā'pratyakṣasya kṣamāpaṇam

where is the fee for the full? libation for the ever-content?
dismissal for the all-pervading? pardon for the unseen?

Pardon for the Unseen

MAHOPADEŚAVIṂŚATIKĀ V.19 · V.19

The ritual closes with forgiveness — and no account to settle.

WHAT IS IT

The four closing rites: dakṣiṇā (fee), tarpaṇa (libation), visarjana (dismissal), kṣamāpaṇa (apology for faults) — all presuppose want, debt, departure and fault in one who is full, content, all-pervading and unseen. The kṣamāpaṇa for the apratyakṣa flips apology into recognition: you apologise to what was never absent.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

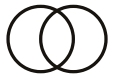
Use it at the end of the bath as the day's closing already: one bow, weight the last word — pardon. The feeling is the end of accounting: no tally of errors, no debt. Guilt arrives, is named as one of the litany's items, and dissolves with the god it expected to offend.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the day's tally closes with one bow — no residue to send off, and the towel-down feels like a clean start, not a reset.

Source: L2-mpa-p02.md · v.19





III

Socialising

out among people

The Speech-Goddess

स्वात्मप्रभां विधाय वाग्देवीं विषयकुसुमकॢप्तार्चः । प्रथमोन्मेषं गुरुम् अथ वन्दित्वा हृदयम् आविश्य

svātmaprabhāṃ vidhāya vāgdevīṃ viṣayakusumakḷptārcaḥ | prathamonmeṣaṃ gurum atha vanditvā hṛdayam āviśya

having made the speech-goddess one's own light, with sense-flowers arranged as offering — bowing to the guru, first unfolding, then entering the heart.

The Speech-Goddess

BHAIRAVĀNUKARAṆA V.7 · BHAIR-P01 V.7

Before you speak: make vāk the light, not the weapon.

WHAT IS IT

The verse sequences the art of speech: svātmaprabhāṃ vidhāya vāgdevīṃ — make the speech-goddess your own light; arrange the sense-flowers as the offering; bow to the guru, the first unfolding (prathamonmeṣa); then enter the heart. Speech is not emitted from the mouth but lit from the heart and offered with the senses.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

Before a difficult conversation, a speech, a message you'll regret: one breath, hand on the throat. Make the speech a light — not a blade. Offering the sense-flowers means: don't weaponise what you've seen and heard. Then speak from the heart-entered place, not the throat.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

before the hard conversation the throat softens — words arrive lit rather than bladed, from the heart-entry and not the throat.

Source: bhairavanukarana.md · bhair-p01 v.7

Every Sound Is Mantra

शब्दः कश्चन यो मुखादुदयते मन्त्रः स लोकोत्तरः संस्थानं सुखदुःखजन्मवपुषो यत्कापि मुद्रैव सा । प्राणस्य स्वरसेन यत्प्रवहणं योगः स एवाद्भुतः शाक्तं धाम परं ममानुभवतः किन्नाम न भ्राजते

śabdaḥ kaścana yo mukhādudayate mantraḥ sa lokottaraḥ saṃsthānaṃ sukhaduḥkhajanmavapuṣo yatkāpi mudraiva sā | prāṇasya svarasena yatpravahaṇaṃ yogaḥ sa evādbhutaḥ śāktaṃ dhāma paraṃ mamānubhavataḥ kinnāma na bhrājate

whatever sound arises from the mouth — that mantra is transcendent. whatever posture of the pleasure-pain-born body — that indeed is mudrā. whatever flowing of breath by its own rhythm — that indeed is wonderful yoga. the supreme śākta abode — while i experience, what indeed would not shine?

Every Sound Is Mantra

ANUBHAVANIVEDANA V.3 · ANU-P03 V.3

Every word out of your mouth is already a mantra. Use that.

WHAT IS IT

Abhinavagupta's experience-report: any sound from the mouth is lokottara mantra — transcendent; any posture is mudrā; any breath-flow by its own rhythm is yoga. Nothing needs to be Sanskritic to be practice. The verse abolishes the distinction between talking and chanting, fidgeting and ritual, breathing and kriyā.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

Use it after you've said something — ordinary, even stupid. That was mantra. The recognition flips the whole day: the meeting, the small talk, the complaint — all of it is mantra, mudrā, yoga, shining.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the mouth registers as temple: ordinary talk is noticed as mantra mid-sentence, and the pause after that noticing is the real one.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the mouth becomes a temple; be careful what you put on the altar.

Source: anubhavanivedana.md · anu-p03 v.3

Enough of Difference-Talk

अलं भेदानुकथया
त्वद्भक्तिरसचर्वणात् ।
सर्वमेकमिदं शान्तमिति वक्तुं
च लज्जते

alaṃ bhedānukathayā tvadbhaktirasacarvaṇāt | sarvamekamidaṃ śāntamiti vaktuṃ ca lajjate

enough of difference-talk — chewing the sap of devotion to you:
all this is one, at peace; and even to say so feels shy.

Enough of Difference-Talk

MAHOPADEŚAVIṂŚATIKĀ V.8 · V.8

Knowing when to stop talking: the oneness embarrasses speech.

WHAT IS IT

Bheda-anukathā, the narration of difference, is abandoned mid-chewing of bhakti-rasa: all is one, at peace. And even to say so feels shy (lajjate) — the verse guards non-duality from becoming a thesis. The oneness is so ordinary that stating it out loud is like announcing a family is at peace: true, and slightly vulgar.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

Use it when an argument about views has you mid-sentence — or when you're about to explain your practice to someone who doesn't need it. Stop. The shyness is the right register.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the argument loses interest halfway through the sentence; the shyness-at-oneness arrives, and silence feels fuller than the winning reply.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

looking away slightly, a small heat in the face — let the body do the disarming.

Source: L2-mpa-p02.md · v.8

When Your Words Are Not Heard

ब्रूषे नोत्तमाङ्ग पश्यसि न मामेतादृशं दुःखितं
विज्ञप्तिं बहुधा कृतां न शृणुषे नायासि मन्मानसे ।
संसारार्णवगर्तमध्यपतितं प्रायेण नालम्बसे
वाक्चक्षुःश्रवणाङ्घ्रिणादिरहितं त्वामाह सत्यं श्रुतिः

brūṣe nottamāṅga paśyasi na māmetādṛśaṃ duḥkhitaṃ vijñaptiṃ bahudhā kṛtāṃ na śṛṇuṣe nāyāsi manmānase | saṃsārārṇavagartamadhyapatitaṃ prāyeṇa nālambase vākcakṣuḥśravaṇāṅghriṇādirahitaṃ tvāmāha satyaṃ śrutiḥ

you speak not, o best-limbed one; you look not upon me, wretched as i am. my entreaty, made in many ways, you hear not; you come not into my mind. fallen amid the pit of the ocean of transmigration, i am mostly left unsupported — yet scripture truly declares you devoid of speech, sight, hearing, feet and the like!

When Your Words Are Not Heard

ABHINAVAGUPTA, PAÑCAŚLOKĪ 3 · PAN-P03

The complaint: you don't speak, look or hear — and scripture says you can't. Ouch.

WHAT IS IT

Pañcaślokī 3 is the reproach: the devotee accuses Śiva of silence — no speech, no glance, no listening, no arrival in the mind — then undercuts himself with scripture's own claim that the Lord is devoid of speech, sight, hearing and feet. The complaint and the theology cancel: you're angry at a god who, by definition, never had a mouth to answer with.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

Use it when you've spoken and nobody heard — human or divine. Say the whole complaint with feeling; the scripture-clause at the end is the punchline that dissolves it.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the not-heard frustration turns to laughter halfway — that laugh is the prasāda, and the complaint self-implodes.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the irritation turns to laughter mid-verse; that laugh is the prasāda.

Source: pancashloki.md · pan-p03





IV

Working

at the desk

Yoke the Mind

एवमेव परा पूजा सर्वावस्थासु सर्वदा । ऐक्यबुद्धया तु सर्वेशे मनो देवे नियोजयेत्

evameva parā pūjā sarvāvasthāsu sarvadā | aikyabuddhayā tu sarveśe mano deve niyojayet

just so is the highest worship — in every state, at all times: with a mind of oneness, one should yoke the mind to god as the lord of all.
17

Yoke the Mind

MAHOPADEŚAVIṂŚATIKĀ V.20 · V.20

The instruction after the litany: work is the highest pūjā.

WHAT IS IT

Parā pūjā is ritual re-specified: all states, all times instead of the fixed occasion, and aikyabuddhi — oneness-mindedness — instead of the duality of giver and gift. The verb is niyojayet, yoke: the mind is a draught-animal that must be hitched, and the yoke is identity. The desk becomes the temple by the hitching, not the décor.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

Before opening the laptop: one line, then begin. The test for aikyabuddhi: the boundary of your skin thins. If it sharpens, you're thinking oneness, not yoking it — drop to the breath and restart. Each task is one yoke; re-hitch as often as needed.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the boundary of your skin thins when the yoke lands; effort turns from strain into celebration — that thinning is aikyabuddhi.

Source: L2-mpa-p02.md · v.20

Achieve God in Activity

शिवो भूत्वा यजेतेति भक्तो भूत्वेति कथ्यते / त्वम् एव हि वपुः सारं भक्तैर् अद्वयशोधितम्

śivo bhūtvā yajeteti bhakto bhūtveti kathyate / tvam eva hi vapuḥ sāraṃ bhaktair advayaśodhitam

so the devotee is told: become śiva and worship. you yourself are the essence of the body, purified by devotion's non-duality.

Achieve God in Activity

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 1.14 · 1.14

Lakshmanjoo's work verse: find God in the activity, not by shunning it.

WHAT IS IT

The verse (śivo bhūtvā yajeti) instructs: become Śiva and worship — and adds that the body's essence (vapuḥ sāraṃ) is refined by bhakti's advaya, non-duality. The gloss from the Academy: achieve God in the activity of the universe, not by shunning it; perceive him in each and every action of life. Work is the field, not the obstacle.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

At the desk, when work feels like a distraction from practice: say it and reclassify. The spreadsheet, the email, the conversation — that is the worship.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the task stops being a distraction from practice: it gets slightly luminous, and you notice you are offering instead of escaping.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the task itself becomes slightly luminous; do it as offering, not as interruption.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 1.14

I-Making Flowers

कुरुते भैरवपूजामनलदलस्थाऽभिमानकुसुमैर्या । नित्यमहङ्कृतिरूपां वन्दे तां शाम्भवीमम्बाम्

kurute bhairavapūjāmanaladalasthā'bhimānakusumairyā |
nityamahaṅkṛtirūpāṃ vande tāṃ śāmbhavīmambām

who performs bhairava's worship, standing in fire's petal, with flowers of i-making — ever of i-making form, i praise her, the mother śāmbhavī.

I-Making Flowers

DEHASTHA V.8 · V.8

Hand the work-ego over: the ahaṃkāra is the offering.

WHAT IS IT

Śāmbhavī stands in the petal of fire and worships with abhimāna-kusuma — flowers of I-making: the sense of mine and I that is normally the problem. The rite converts the fault into the flower. At work, the 'I' that wants credit is not suppressed — it is picked and placed in the fire.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

When the ego flares mid-task — pride, irritation at the colleague, hunger for recognition: see it as a flower, pick it, place it at the heart's fire. Three flowers are enough.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the work-ego flares — the credit-want — is picked as a flower and placed; relief at the solar plexus, fire-warmth confirming the placement.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

relief, like putting down a bag; the fire (warmth at the solar plexus) confirms it.

Source: deha-p01.md · v.8

When Your Form Expands

त्वत्स्वरूपे जृम्भमाणे त्वं चाहं चाखिलं जगत्। जाते तस्य तिरोधाने न त्वं नाहं न वै जगत्

tvatsvarūpe jṛmbhamāṇe tvaṃ cāhaṃ cākhilaṃ jagat | jāte tasya tirodhāne na tvaṃ nāhaṃ na vai jagat

when your own form expands — you and i and the whole world.
when its withdrawal is born — neither you, nor i, nor indeed the world.

When Your Form Expands

MAHOPADEŚAVIṂŚATIKĀ V.9 · V.9

Expansion and withdrawal: the world is his inhale and exhale.

WHAT IS IT

Two movements: when svarūpa expands (jṛmbhamāṇe), you, I and the whole world appear together; when it withdraws (tirodhāne), none of the three remains. The verse relativises the entire workday — deadlines, colleagues, the self doing them — as one expansion of his form. Not nihilism: the expansion is real, and so is who expands it.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

Use it at the overwhelm point — too much to do, the self tightening. Say it and feel the day as one exhale of a larger form. The overwhelm thins because the 'me' carrying it is part of the expansion, not its owner. Then return to the next small task.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the overwhelm thins because the self carrying it is shown as part of the expansion; the next small task becomes doable without a push.

Source: L2-mpa-p01.md · v.9





V

Eating

before eating

The Meal Offering

ब्रह्मार्पणं ब्रह्म हविर् ब्रह्माग्नौ ब्रह्मणा हुतम्। ब्रह्मैव तेन गन्तव्यं ब्रह्मकर्मसमाधिना॥

brahmārpaṇaṁ brahma havir brahmāgnau brahmaṇā hutam | brahmaiva tena gantavyaṁ brahmakarmasamādhinā ||

the offering is brahman / the oblation is brahman / poured by brahman into the fire of brahman / brahman alone is reached / by one absorbed in the action that is brahman

The Meal Offering

BHAGAVAD GĪTĀ 4.24 (LAKSHMANJOO MEALTIME YAJÑA) · GĪTĀ 4.24

The meal prayer: water in the palm, one verse, and eating becomes worship.

WHAT IS IT

Lakshmanjoo read brahman throughout as Lord Śiva. Four things are named — the offering, the oblation, the fire, the goal — and all four are the same substance. What you take is offered to Śiva; what you offer is itself Śiva; the stomach is Śiva's residence. The logic collapses the distance between eater, food and eaten into one taste.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

Before the first bite: put a little water in the palm, look at the food, and say the verse once. Then eat as if the meal is being offered into a fire — slowly, without hurry. The feeling to find: gratitude with heat. Nothing extra; the verse does the whole work.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the food stops being grabbed: one conscious bite before the first chew, and the meal proceeds without hurry — that is the yajña running.

Source: mealtime-yajna.md · Gītā 4.24

Śiva Bows to Śiva

अस्मद्रूप समाविष्टः स्वात्मनात्म निवारणे । शिवः करोतु निजया नमः शक्त्या ततात्मने ॥

asmadrūpa samāviṣṭaḥ svātmanātma nivāraṇe | śivaḥ karotu nijayā namaḥ śaktyā tatātmane ||

śiva, having entered the form that is myself, bows — by his own power — to śiva, for the removal of the obstacle that is himself.

Śiva Bows to Śiva

SOMANANDA, ŚIVADṚṢṬI 7.103 (MEALTIME LORE) · ŚIVADṚṢṬI 7.103 (PROVISIONAL)

The obstacle on the plate is also Śiva. Say it before food.

WHAT IS IT

The whole Trika in one bow: the one who bows, the one bowed to, the obstacle being removed, and the power doing the removing are all Śiva. Nothing is outside the recognition — not even the thing that blocks it. Lakshmanjoo taught this verse alongside the mealtime practice.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

Say it silently as the food arrives. The 'obstacle' can be anything — the craving, the guilt, the person you're eating with. Name it, then let the verse dissolve it.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the obstacle met before the meal — the craving, the mood — gets put down mid-meal; the relief you feel is the obstacle removed, not the food absorbed.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the moment of placing should feel like relief, like putting something down.

Source: mealtime-yajna.md · Śivadṛṣṭi 7.103 (provisional)

The Sense-Goddesses Offer Bhairava

आत्मीयविषयभोगैरिन्द्रियदेव्यः सदा हृदम्भोजे । अभिपूजयन्ति यं तं चिन्मयमानन्दभैरवं वन्दे

ātmīyaviṣayabhogairindriyadevyaḥ sadā hṛdambhoje | abhipūjayanti yaṃ taṃ cinmayamānandabhairavaṃ vande

with feasts of their own sense-objects, the sense-goddesses ever worship, in the heart-lotus, him — the consciousness-made bliss-bhairava: i praise.

The Sense-Goddesses Offer Bhairava

DEHASTHA V.5 · V.5

Every taste is already a pūjā happening in the heart.

WHAT IS IT

Dehastha inverts the usual charge against the senses: the senses are goddesses (indriya-devyāḥ), and their enjoyment of their objects is continuous worship of the Bhairava made of consciousness. Eating is the oldest form of practice — the offering is already being made in the heart-lotus.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

At the first bite, feel the heart-lotus (just behind the centre of the chest) as the altar and the flavour as the flower landing on it. Three bites only — overdoing it kills the taste. The feeling: gratitude with heat. The sense is honoured as a goddess, not supervised as a thief.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

on bite three the chest warms and the flavour deepens: sensation has turned into offering, and the warmth is the goddess receiving.

Source: deha-p01.md · v.5

Devouring Māyā as Food

मायीयकालनियतिरागाद्याहारतर्पिताः / चरन्ति सुखिनो नाथ भक्तिमन्तो जगत्तटे

māyīyakālaniyatirāgādyāhāratarpitāḥ / caranti sukhino nātha bhaktimanto jagattaṭe

o nātha, your devotees roam happy on the shore of the world, filled and satisfied by consuming māyā, time, fate and desire themselves.
24

Devouring Māyā as Food

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 15.2 · 15.2

The devotee's menu: māyā, time, niyati, desire — eaten for breakfast.

WHAT IS IT

The verse is a mealtime paradox: the devotees are tarpitāḥ, sated, by consuming māyīya, kāla, niyati, rāgādi — the very forces that starve everyone else. What the world treats as hunger (desire, fate, time) is their food. They roam happy on the shore of the world, having eaten the ocean.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

Before or after a meal, when desire is loudest: name it as the course — māyā, time, fate, desire — and eat it. The hunger is the menu.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the craving names itself as a course before it is obeyed, and the second helping finds you already full — tarpitāḥ, sated.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the wanting transforms into satedness mid-sentence; that flip is the verse working.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 15.2





VI

Waiting

in the in-between

I Don't Mind

विषमस्थो ऽपि स्वस्थो ऽपि रुदन्न् अपि हसन्न् अपि / गम्भीरो ऽपि विचित्तो ऽपि भवेयं भक्तितः प्रभो

viṣamastho 'pi svastho 'pi rudann api hasann api / gambhīro 'pi vicitto 'pi bhaveyaṃ bhaktitaḥ prabho

in crisis or at ease, weeping or laughing, grave or unhinged — by devotion, lord, let me be so.

I Don't Mind

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 16.8 · 16.8

The api-chain refuses resolution: everything is allowed.

WHAT IS IT

The verse piles up opposites with 'api' (even): viṣama/sthāna (crisis/peace), rudann/hasann (weeping/laughing), gambhīro/vicitta (grave/unhinged). Devotion is not the absence of any of them; it is what holds them. The prayer does not ask for calm — it asks to be devotion through whatever arrives.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

Use it when waiting has turned into agitation — a queue, a delay, a message that won't come. Say it once inwardly. Don't wait for composure: the very mess is the place where devotion can be.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the irritation keeps its heat but loses its argument: you catch yourself reciting instead of replaying.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the shoulders drop half a millimetre; that's the api doing its work.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 16.8

In Every Action

अनुभूयासमीशान प्रतिकर्म क्षणात् क्षणम् / भवत्पूजामृतापानमदा स्वादमहामुदम्

anubhūyāsamīśāna pratikarma kṣaṇāt kṣaṇam /
bhavatpūjāmṛtāpānamadāsvādamahāmudam

o lord, may i experience, moment by moment, in every action,
the great joy of drinking the nectar of your worship.

In Every Action

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 17.19 · 17.19

The in-between moment becomes the practice itself.

WHAT IS IT

Utpaladeva prays for the taste of worship inside every action — not more ritual, but the nectar of pūjā in the ordinary. 'Moment by moment' (kṣaṇāt kṣaṇam) is the whole method: the repeated return of attention. Waiting is full of kṣaṇas — this verse makes them the site of the drink.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

At any transition or pause: say it once, then take one breath as if that breath were the nectar. Don't manufacture joy — notice the small lift that a pause already gives. Three pauses, three sips, and the waiting has changed colour.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

three transitions, three sips — ordinary acts start tasting charged; the walk to the kettle becomes the practice.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 17.19

Abandon Nothing, Grasp Nothing

संसारो ऽस्ति न तत्त्वतस् तनुभृतां बन्धस्य वार्तैव
का बन्धो यस्य न जातु तस्य वितथा मुक्तस्य
मुक्तिक्रिया । मिथ्यामोहकृद् एष
रज्जुभुजगच्छायापिशाचभ्रमो मा किंचित् त्यज
मा गृहाण विहर स्वस्थो यथावस्थितः

saṃsāro 'sti na tattvatas tanubhṛtāṃ bandhasya vārtaiva kā bandho yasya na jātu tasya vitathā muktasya muktikriyā | mithyāmohakṛd eṣa rajjubhujagacchāyāpiśācabhramo mā kiṃcit tyaja mā gṛhāṇa vihara svastho yathāvasthitaḥ

saṃsāra is not, in truth, for body-holders — of bondage, what news? bondage never truly is for anyone — so for the free, liberation-rite is false. this error-maker is rope-snake-shadow-ghost-delusion. abandon nothing; grasp nothing; live healthy, staying as you are.

Abandon Nothing, Grasp Nothing

ABHINAVAGUPTA, ANUTTARĀṢṬIKĀ V.2 · ANU-P02 V.2

The waiting instruction par excellence: don't add, don't subtract, just stay.

WHAT IS IT

The verse dismantles bondage itself — saṃsāra never truly was; the bondage-story is the rope-snake-shadow ghost of māyā. Then the instruction in four beats: mā kiṃcit tyaja (abandon nothing), mā gṛhāṇa (grasp nothing), vihara (live), svastho yathāvasthitaḥ (stay as you are). Waiting is where the mind most wants to add or subtract.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

In the queue, the delay, the silence: say the last line — 'live healthy, staying as you are.' The restlessness wants to grab something or drop something; the verse forbids both.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the hands open and close once, then rest; the restless grab-urge passes through without finding anything to hold.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the hands open and close once, then rest; the waiting is now the living.

Source: anuttarastika.md · anu-p02 v.2

Two Classes of People

न किञ्चिद् एव लोकानां भवदावरणं प्रति यत् किं चिद् एव भूतानां

na kiñcid eva lokānāṃ bhavadāvaraṇaṃ prati yat kiṃ cid eva bhūtānāṃ

there are two classes found in this universe: one class is of ordinary people, and another are those who are thy devotees.

Two Classes of People

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 16.1 · 16.1

In the queue: two kinds of people, and you know which you are.

WHAT IS IT

The verse is a quiet census — only two classes, ordinary folk and bhaktas — with no third category of the merely interested. It's a wry re-classification of the crowd: everyone waiting with you belongs to one of two groups, and the difference isn't visible from the outside. The devotee smiles at the census.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

Use it in any crowd — the queue, the train, the meeting. Run the census once: two classes. Then check which one is noticing the census.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

a private smile in the crowd — and no one can tell which class anyone is; that invisibility is the census working.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

a small private smile; nobody can tell from the outside which class you're in — that's the point.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 16.1





VII

Healing

illness · pain

No Fear-Talk

स्वात्मनि विश्वगये त्वयि नाथे
तेन न संसृतिभीतिकथास्ति ।
सत्स्व् अपि
दुर्धरदुःखविमोहत्रासविधायिषु
कर्मगणेषु

svātmani viśvagaye tvayi nāthe tena na saṃsṛtibhītikathāsti | satsv api durdharaduḥkhavimohatrāsavidhāyiṣu karmagaṇeṣu

with you as lord, all-pervading in own self — therefore no talk of transmigration-fear. even though hard-to-bear suffering, delusion, terror-causing karma-hosts are present.

No Fear-Talk

ABHINAVAGUPTA, BHAIRAVASTAVA 3 · BH-P03

The suffering is conceded; the fear-talk is not.

WHAT IS IT

The verse does not deny suffering — it concedes the karma-hosts (durdharaduḥkhavimohatrāsavidhāyiṣu) — but denies the fear of saṃsāra, because the Lord is all-pervading in the self. Suffering can be present without being feared; the fear-talk is what stops.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

When negative, say it and let the concession stand: yes, this is hard; and the fear of it is separate from the pain itself. The verse splits them.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

named fears lose volume: you list four, and the inventory ends lighter — the exhale after the last line is the refuge-line landing.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the pain stays, the story about the pain thins. That thinning is the verse working.

Source: bhairavastava.md · bh-p03

Forgetting, and the Final Plea

यातस्त्वत्सहवासतो बहुतरः कालो वतास्मिन् क्षणे किं किं वा न कृतं त्वया वरगुरूपासानिमित्तेन मे। वारं वारमहं पुनर्निरुपमां दिव्यं भुवं प्रासुवत्कायस्त्वां किल विस्मरामि यदतः स्थेयं न भूयस्त्वया

yātastvatsahavāsato bahutaraḥ kālo vatāsmin kṣaṇe kiṃ kiṃ vā na kṛtaṃ tvayā varagurūpāsānimittena me / vāraṃ vāramahaṃ punarnirupamāṃ divyaṃ bhuvaṃ prāsuvatkāyastvāṃ kila vismarāmi yadataḥ stheyaṃ na bhūyastvayā

much time dwelling with you has passed — alas, in this very moment! what, what has not been done by you for me, for the sake of serving the excellent guru! again and again i, whose body has attained the incomparable divine plane — yet indeed i forget you. therefore, by you let there be no further staying-away!

Forgetting, and the Final Plea

ABHINAVAGUPTA, PAÑCAŚLOKĪ 5 · PAN-P05

The illness plea: you've done everything for me — so don't stay away now.

WHAT IS IT

Pañcaślokī 5 turns on time and forgetting: much time has passed with him; nothing has not been done for you; and still you forget him. The plea — let there be no further staying-away — is asked not from desert but from a record of grace: you owe nothing, he has paid everything, so his absence now would be the only unkindness left.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

When ill and feeling forgotten: say the whole verse as the complaint it is — 'what has not been done by you for me?' — and let the last line be the request.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the guilt of forgotten-prayer is spoken once and stops growing; the complaint shrinks mid-verse, which is the plea becoming fair.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the forgetting is admitted first (you forgot him); the plea is fair because of that. One round, then rest.

Source: pancashloki.md · pan-p05

Dance with the Foot-Dust

भवत्पादाम्बुजरजोराजि रञ्जितमूर्धजः / अपाररभसारब्धनर्तनः स्याम् अहं कदा

bhavatpādāmbujarajorājirañjitamūrdhajaḥ / apārarabhasārabdhanartanaḥ syām ahaṃ kadā

when will that glorious day come to me, my lord — your lotus-foot dust anointing my hair — that i may dance the dance begun from the endless?

Dance with the Foot-Dust

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 5.2 · 5.2

For the sickbed: the day I dance with your foot-dust on my head.

WHAT IS IT

The verse is pure longing — kadā, when: when will my hair be rubbed with the dust of your lotus feet, and I dance a dance begun from the boundless? The foot-dust is the classical sign of total surrender — the head as the lowest place, the master's foot as the highest — and the dance is what follows: not recovery as return to normal, but entry into a dance that starts at the infinite.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

From the sickbed, say it as a question — kadā, when — without demanding the answer today. Picture only the dust on the hair; the dance can wait.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the asking stops straining: kadā moves from the clock into the chest, and the sickbed stops demanding a date.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

longing itself becomes the posture; the verse sanctifies not-yet.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 5.2

Whatever Is Seen Is You

अन्तर्देहे मया नित्यं त्वमात्मा च गवेषितः । न दृष्टस्त्वं नचैवात्मा यच्च दृष्टं त्वमेव तत्

antardehe mayā nityaṃ tvamātmā ca gaveṣitaḥ | na dṛṣṭastvaṃ nacaivātmā yacca dṛṣṭaṃ tvameva tat

inside the body, sought by me always — you as self, and the self is never seen. whatever is seen is you alone, that.

Whatever Is Seen Is You

MAHOPADEŚAVIṂŚATIKĀ V.3 · V.3

When the body hurts: whatever is seen — even this — is you.

WHAT IS IT

The verse performs a swap: I search for you inside the body as the self, and the self is never seen — but whatever IS seen, tvameva tat, is you alone. Applied to illness: the pain, the weakness, the scanned body — none of it is the self, and all of it is him. The sick body becomes the visible half of an invisible lord.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

When pain or weakness is present: look at it once — the ache as an object — and name it 'seen: you.' Not as denial of pain but as address change.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the ache is looked at once and addressed as 'seen: you' — it stays, but loses its claim to be yours; the body reads as visible deity.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the pain stays but loses its claim to be yours; it's his visible side, and visibility is already grace.

Source: L2-mpa-p01.md · v.3





VIII

Sleeping

wind down · lights out

From Your Waking, His Waking

त्वत्प्रबोधात् प्रबोधोऽस्य त्वन्निद्रातो लयोऽस्य यत् । अतस्त्वदात्मकं सर्वं विश्व सदसदात्मकम्

tvatprabodhāt prabodho'sya tvannidrāto layo'sya yat | atastvadātmakaṃ sarvaṃ viśva sadasadātmakam

from your waking comes his waking; from your sleep comes his merging. hence all is of your nature — the world, both real and unreal.

From Your Waking, His Waking

MAHOPADEŚAVIṂŚATIKĀ V.11 · V.11

Your sleep does not stop the world — it feeds it.

WHAT IS IT

Two transfers: prabodha (waking) passes from you to him, laya (dissolution) from his sleep to the world. Because his waking enlivens the world and his sleep dissolves it, everything is tvad-ātmaka, of your nature. Sleep is not the end of practice but its most global act: when you sleep you participate in his laya.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

Last line of the day. Lie down and take one awake minute: you are about to do what he does at night. Don't stay awake doing this — fall asleep inside the thought.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the day's edges soften as the eyes close: tasks stop glowing red, and the world is visibly laid down with you.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

as the eyes close, feel the day's edges get soft, 'unreal' — that softening is sadasadātmakam. If anxious at night, this dissolves the day rather than reviewing it.

Source: L2-mpa-p02.md · v.11

In Sleep, When the Outer Range Perished

अनागतायां निद्रायाम्
प्रणष्टे बाह्यगोचरे ।
सावस्था मनसा गम्या
परा देवी प्रकाशते

anāgatāyāṃ nidrāyām praṇaṣṭe bāhyagocare | sāvasthā manasā gamyā parā devī prakāśate

in the not-yet-come sleep, when the outer range has perished — that state, to be gone to by mind, the supreme goddess shines forth.

In Sleep, When the Outer Range Perished

VIJÑĀNA BHAIRAVA V.75 · V.75

The instruction for the moment before sleep: go there by mind.

WHAT IS IT

Three conditions: sleep that has not yet arrived; once the outer field has died. In that gap, to be gone to by mind, parā devī, the supreme Goddess, shines — not is-made. The verse locates practice in the dying of the outer senses, where consciousness is neither awake nor asleep, and names what appears there as Śakti herself.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

At lights-out, on your back, one hand on the belly. Wait for the outer field to fade — sounds go dull, images slow. Then instead of following sleep passively, send the mind as an arrow to the heart-centre, once. Then release. The Goddess-feel is a hum or warmth behind the chest; if images swarm you have grasped — release and let the hum carry. Single-shot: no repetitions.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the outer field dies and a hum or warmth settles behind the chest. images swarm means you grasped — release shows as the hum returning.

Source: vbt-p08.md · v.75

At Your Cool Feet

अशेषविषयाशून्यश्रीस
माश्लेषसुस्थितः /
शयीयम् इव
शीताङ्घ्रिकुशेशययुगे
कदा

aśeṣaviṣayāśūnyaśrīsamāśleṣasusthitaḥ / śayīyam iva śītāṅghrikuśeśayayuge kadā

when will i lie down — free of every object, settled in the embrace of undiminished glory — at your two cool lotus feet?

At Your Cool Feet

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 9.14 · 9.14

The sleep prayer: the cool feet are the peace after the fever of wanting.

WHAT IS IT

Utpaladeva asks when he will lie down free of every object (aśeṣaviṣaya — no grasping left), settled in undiminished glory (aśūnya śrī), at the two cool lotus feet (śītāṅghri-kuśeśaya). 'Free of every object' is not blankness but the rest that remains when the mind stops reaching. The cool feet are the peace of Śiva.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

In bed. Say it once, then let the image of the two cool feet form under the mind's eye — no details needed, just the coolness. The feeling to find: the fever of the day dropping. If the mind races, return to the coolness, not the words.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the fever of wanting drops half a degree, and sleep arrives at the cool place instead of collapsing into the dark.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 9.14

Bliss Is the Forgotten Treasure

आनन्दो ऽत्र न वित्तमध्यमदवन् नैवाङ्गनासङ्गवत्
दीपार्केन्दुकृतप्रभाप्रकरवन् नैव प्रकाशोदयः ।
हर्षः संभृतभेदमुक्तिसुखभूर् भारावतारोपमः
सर्वाद्वैतपदस्य विस्मृतनिधेः प्राप्तिः प्रकाशोदयः

ānando 'tra na vittamadhyamadavan naivāṅganāsaṅgavat
dīpārkendukṛtaprabhāprakaravan naiva prakāśodayaḥ | harṣaḥ
saṃbhṛtabhedamuktisukhabhūr bhārāvatāropamaḥ sarvādvaitapadasya
vismṛtanidheḥ prāptiḥ prakāśodayaḥ

bliss here is not wealth-middle-intoxication, nor like enjoying women, nor lamp-sun-moon-made splendour-multitude — and not the light-rise either. joy with gathered-difference-liberation-bliss-ground, like burden-lowering, is the attainment of the forgotten treasure of the all-nonduality state — the light-rise.

Bliss Is the Forgotten Treasure

ABHINAVAGUPTA, ANUTTARĀṢṬIKĀ V.4 · ANU-P04 V.4

The sleep verse: bliss as burden-lowering, the forgotten treasure.

WHAT IS IT

The verse defines bliss by negation — not wealth-drunkenness, not sensual pleasure, not spectacle-light — then gives the positive: harṣa like bhārāvatāra, the lowering of a burden, is the prāpti of vismṛta-nidhi, the forgotten treasure of the non-dual state. Falling into sleep is that burden-lowering: the day's weight set down at the door.

HOW TO PERFORM IT

In bed, say it and feel the day's weight as the literal bhāra being lowered. Bliss here is not an event but an unloading.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

the weight lowers physically — shoulders deeper, jaw looser; the day's load was the bhāra, and it is down.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the shoulders drop a centimetre deeper each line; by the last line the bed has the treasure under it.

Source: anuttarastika.md · anu-p04 v.4

ॐ शान्तिः शान्तिः शान्तिः

PRACTICAL PRAYERS

The day, complete From the first light to the last breath, the day is one sequence of recognitions: you wake into his waking, wash a body that is his temple, walk out among his forms, work as his yoke, eat his offering, wait in his pace, meet your negatives as his play, rejoice in his victory, and hand the night back to his sleep. The prayers are small; the day is the practice.

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